

TERRA INFIRMA

ACROSS BORDER: A man with daughter amidst the debris at Balakot, Pakistan



AP PHOTO/BK BANAGASHI

REWIND

An earthquake measuring 7.6 struck the Indo-Pak border on October 8 killing 80,000 people and leaving millions homeless, with the worst of the Himalayan winters ahead. The quake, which had its epicentre at Muzaffarabad in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, sheared off entire hillsides, snapping the region's already perilous communication link with the rest of the Valley. Such was the damage that when Prime Minister Manmohan Singh visited the affected areas, he called upon the "resilience of the nation" to tide over it. Bitter rivalry between the two nations did not deter the people of India and Pakistan from helping their brethren across the LoC.

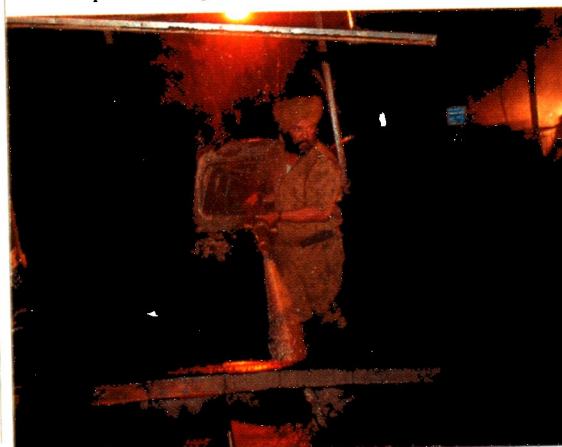
FIRST CUT

• Stitching up the ties, the first Indo-Pak bus service across the LoC was started on April 7 between Srinagar and Muzaffarpur.

• The era of Lalu Prasad Yadav came to an end in Bihar as he was ousted by Nitish Kumar. It was corruption, lawlessness and lack of development that brought an end to his 15-year rule as chief minister.

DARK DIWALI

Diwali in Delhi saw the macabre victory of evil over good as three bombs went off on October 29 in Sarojini Nagar, Paharganj and on a bus near Govindpuri, killing 63 people and injuring 200. The Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Toiba was a prime suspect in the attack.



SUMEET INDER SINGH